

Expanding Single Brackets

Example

$$3(x + 2)$$

Under the Bridge

Over the Rainbow

Step 1:

Multiply 'under the bridge'

$$3(x + 2)$$

$$3 \times x = 3x$$

Step 2:

Multiply 'over the rainbow'

$$3(x + 2)$$

$$3 \times +2 = +6$$

Step 3:

You have now fully expanded your single bracket.

$$3(x + 2)$$

your final answer is $3x + 6$

Example

$$2x(4x - 2)$$

Under the Bridge

Over the Rainbow

Step 1:

Multiply 'under the bridge'

$$2x(4x - 2)$$

$$2x \times 4x = 8x^2$$

Step 2:

Multiply 'over the rainbow'

$$2x(4x - 2)$$

$$2x \times -2 = -4x$$

Step 3:

You have now fully expanded your single bracket.

$$2x(4x - 2)$$

your final answer is $8x^2 - 4x$